

Wright brothers did not know of such things, nor did Henry Ford or Andrew Carnegie or Thomas Edison. A young man named Merlyn Mickelson, in 1955, looked at the rapidly dawning computer age and saw what every age offers—a need and a way to fill it. He started to manufacture memory cores in his basement. His first investment in tools and supplies came to \$7.21. His first employees were friends and neighboring housewives who “pitched in.” Today, not yet forty, Mr. Mickelson still makes memory cores. He is President and 75 per cent owner of a \$16-million-a-year company, and the company stock he holds is worth about \$47 million.

Can success consciousness be instilled into a mind already filled with a record of failure? When you come to know your own mind and live your own life, you can wipe out a record of failure just as surely as you can erase the message on a tape recorder, leaving a wonderfully receptive tape—or mind—to receive new and better impressions.

Some people have been able to do this for themselves. Others need help. I well remember a man I helped to find himself. As you will see, I got him started and once he knew where he was going, he did the rest.

This was a dead-broke man just out of the Army. I believe he used the Army as a refuge, but eventually he was back in civilian clothes, looking for a job. The mere mention of “hard times” seemed to be enough to flatten him. He was shabby. He was hungry. He was willing to settle for crumbs if only he could get them.

He came to see me about finding work. At the outset he announced: “All I want is a place to sleep and enough to eat.”

A place to sleep and enough to eat—in a world that throbs with riches!

Something prompted me to ask: “Why settle for a meal ticket? How would you like to become a millionaire?”

He looked at me with glassy eyes, swaying. “Please don’t joke with me.”

“I assure you I’m serious. Every man has some kind of assets, and every man can turn his assets into a million dollars or many millions if he uses them correctly.”

He sighed. “What do you mean by assets? I have a nickel in my pocket.”

“Bring your mind around to the positive side,” I said, “and you have the most important asset you’ll ever have. We’ll